NEPQ Phase 1 — Connection

Cheat sheet · 4 Nov 2026

Purpose

Get the prospect relaxed and talking about themselves, so they lower their guard and give honest answers later. **Rapport first, problems later.**

Do / Don't

Do	Don't
Keep the focus on the prospect, not you	Open with a rigid agenda
Be curious, ask open questions	Push your authority or credentials
Keep it low-pressure and relaxed	Ask for a decision upfront
Save deep, probing questions for later	Dig into their problems straight away

What to find out

Only two things at this stage:

1. **Why they're here** — what made them take the call or reach out.

2. **Their broad goal** — what they want overall (e.g. lose weight, get a better car). Not the detailed problem yet.

Why it works: pushy tactics trigger sales resistance and the prospect shuts down. Like any conversation, people only open up about personal stuff once trust is built. Relaxed prospect = better, more honest answers in later phases.

Self-check after each call

- ■ Did the prospect talk more than me?
- ■ Did I learn why they engaged and their main goal?
- ■ Did they stay relaxed, or did I see resistance?
- ■ Did I hold back the deep questions?

Next phase: Situation — exploring their current situation and problems, built on the trust from this phase.